



Mishi Choudhary, executive director, Software Freedom Law Centre, speaking about legal issues related to free and open source compliance



Naren Datta, researcher, Microsoft Research India, talking about WikiBhasha



Anurup M of Huawei Technologies India speaking on 'Optimising the Linux Kernel for High Performance Systems'. Aman Shahi and Irfan U R Rehman of Huawei were co-speakers



Sebastian Bergmann, creator of PHPUnit and co-founder of thePHPCc, speaks on integrating a PHP project with Jenkins

of open source and also mentioned how Yahoo! is opening up its software and platforms for others to use. Yehuda added, "By doing this, we also get better resources for software development."

Madan Mohan M, chief architect, 3i Infotech, was host of the CIO summit. The panel discussion that followed took a lively turn when two of the panellists stated that open source is not always the best solution. Rama Ramakrishna, director, Software Engineering, Dell India R&D Centre, was the panel chair.

Varad Gupta and Jyoti Bacche (two of the five panellists) were of the view that open source gives an enterprise a competitive edge as users and open source companies can be freed from vendor lock-ins. It gives them the freedom to choose any support provider as the source code is open, and there is healthy competition between vendors. This drives down the cost of support. However, in case of closed or proprietary solutions, there is a fixed price attached and no choice of support vendors. You have no freedom of choice, they expressed.

Bacche stated, "With shorter lifecycles of projects, everything gets outsourced. People have moved to using libraries and agile modes. With proprietary solutions, either the entire software gets replaced or the end user lives with the problem and pays a higher cost for support. In the case of open source, they can get people who have knowledge of the programming language on which the source is developed, or they can approach any of the support providers. They can debug and fix it easily."

Venkat Mangudi of Venkat Mangudi Consulting and Yehuda took the stand that both proprietary and open source software have their own value. Yehuda said that enterprises should opt for packaged specific software according to their needs. "If an enterprise has to choose between proprietary and open source software, the primary considerations are interoperability, support and cost. While both offer interoperability and support, the cost of usage also comes into the picture. When an open source alternative is available, go for it; but when it does not meet your needs, you have to choose proprietary and specialised software," he added. Some in the audience also pointed out how they tried open source for CRM but had to replace it with either proprietary or other open source solutions because of the problems they faced.

Hands-on workshops

The much talked about Open Source India 2011 was not only a platform to hear renowned OS luminaries share their thoughts but also provided the attendees with an excellent opportunity to get hands-on training with many open source tools. Workshops on 'Cloud Foundry' by VMware, 'openLDAP and HA Clustering on RHEL5' by Keen and Able Computers, 'MySQL' by Oracle, 'Leaner Techniques for Faster Portals—Get Drupalled' by AZRI Solutions, 'Doctrine 2' by Juozas Kaziukenas, founder and CEO of Web Species Ltd, and many others were very well received. All this and a lot more was packed into the three-day event.

For those of you who missed being part of the event this year, don't lose hope! The next edition of the event will be held at Bengaluru's NIMHANS Convention Centre yet again from October 12 to 14, 2012. Team OSI is already gathering views and feedback from the recently concluded event with an aim to make the 9th edition of OSI even better than before!